

À■■: DRUMFALL

Every blow is a word. Every fight is a song. Do not let the world go silent.

STORY BIBLE • GAME DESIGN CONCEPT • CONTEST PITCH

Project status: Concept / pre-production pitch. This presentation summarises the submitted story bible and game design document; proposed features are not represented as completed development.

01 / THE PITCH

When the Great Drum that keeps heaven and earth in rhythm is stolen and silenced, Ògún, the exiled war-god and maker of the Iron Road, must reunite the quarrelling òrì■à, recover the Drum's Three Voices, and confront Ìdák■■—the Silence growing from forgotten names, unspoken grief, and unmourned dead.

GENRE	PLAYER PROMISE
Mythic action brawler with rhythm-based combat.	Every fight becomes call-and-response: read the beat, answer the enemy, and turn rhythm into power.
SIGNATURE SYSTEM	**CHOICE & CONSEQUENCE**
Three combat tones, drum-phrase responses, Oríkì-inspired combos, and the À■■ Gauge.	The Mend-or-Slay path shapes Ògún's powers and contributes to three possible endings through the Ìwà meter.

WHY IT STANDS OUT

- Distinct identity: Yoruba-inspired mythology with rhythm as a core combat language.
- Emotional engine: memory, grief, responsibility, and the cost of violence.
- Expandable structure: campaign, boss encounters, co-op and competitive modes are outlined in the source GDD.

02 / WORLD & CHARACTERS

A mythic world inspired by Yoruba cosmology, where Ayé (Earth), Òrun (the realm of the gods), and the scarred land of Ire are linked by the Iron Road and the Great Drum, Ìlù À■■. The art direction pairs indigo adire patterns with gold, brass, iron, woven light, and an Afro-mythic futurist vision.

VISUAL LANGUAGE

Indigo adire patterns • gold and brass • forged iron • terracotta and bronze • woven light • ancient-meets-future architecture

CORE CAST

Ògún Iron Road-maker and protagonist	**■àngó** Thunder king and proud rival
■■■un River queen; heals, nurtures, restores	**■ya** Storm and gatekeeper
È■ù Crossroads trickster and narrator	**Ìdák■■** The Silence; central antagonist

THE CENTRAL CONFLICT

The Great Drum, Ìlù À■■, is the heartbeat of creation. When Ìdák■■ steals it, the Iron Road breaks and the world begins to lose sound, colour, and memory. Ògún must confront both the Silence and the parts of himself it reflects.

03 / GAMEPLAY & CAMPAIGN

Talking-drum combat makes rhythm a readable tactical language: three tones shape attack lanes; enemies call out rhythmic phrases that players answer; Oríkì-inspired combos reward expressive play; Ifá Cast offers a pre-mission rule-changing choice; and the Mend-or-Slay path shapes Ògún's power and the game's three possible endings.

CAMPAIGN ARC

The Silent Drum	The Great Drum falls silent in Ire.
Broken Alliances	Ògún and È■ù cross a failing Iron Road and reunite divided powers.
Ire Revealed	A descent beneath Ire exposes the grief and violence buried in the past.
The Hollow	The gods confront Ìdák■■, who takes Ògún's form.
The Road Remembered	The Iron Road reopens; player choices shape the resolution.

PLAYER EXPERIENCE GOALS

• Readable combat: rhythm cues should remain clear and accessible.

• Meaningful choice: the Ìwà meter connects combat decisions to character development and endings.

• Accessibility: the source GDD includes visual alternatives to colour-only cues and control considerations.

• Expandable design: additional modes and progression are planned in the larger design document.

04 / CULTURAL INTEGRITY & PRODUCTION VISION

The source document calls for paid Yoruba cultural advisors, native-speaker language review, respect for living religious practice, acknowledgement of regional and diaspora variants, and avoidance of stereotypes or closed sacred knowledge. This should remain a visible production commitment.

PRODUCTION PRINCIPLES

Consultation

Engage and fairly pay Yoruba cultural advisors, practitioners, historians, poets, and language specialists from the beginning.

Accuracy

Use correct Yoruba diacritics and native-speaker review; acknowledge regional and diaspora variations.

Respect

Avoid caricature, stereotypes, and depictions of closed sacred knowledge. Distinguish traditional sources from original inventions.

Transparency

Keep the pitch honest about the project's concept stage and validate scope, budget, team, and technical feasibility before making production commitments.

NEXT STEPS FOR A CONTEST-READY SUBMISSION

• Replace [Studio / Author Name] in the source document with your professional name or studio.

• Add a short creator bio, contact email, and a clear statement of your role.

• If available, include original character sketches, UI mock-ups, or a short prototype; label concept art versus implemented work.

• Publish the portfolio on Behance and place the full GDD in a public repository or accessible PDF link if the contest permits.

• Test every link in a signed-out/incognito browser before submitting.

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